

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



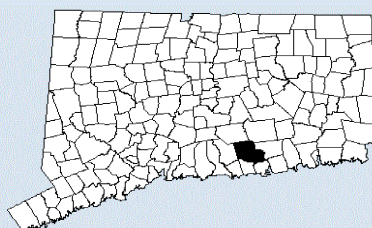
Regional School District 04

Brian White, Superintendent • 860-526-2417 • <http://www.reg4.k12.ct.us>

District Information

Grade Range	7-12
Number of Schools/Programs	3
Enrollment	723
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$27,347
Total Expenditures ¹	\$20,729,288

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	343	47.4	48.3
Male	373	51.6	51.5
Non-Binary	7	1.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	8	1.1	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	74	10.2	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	29	4.0	4.7
White	603	83.4	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	18	2.5	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	212	29.3	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	141	19.5	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	72	19.5	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	16	21.9	*	*
White	113	19.1	23	3.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	67	33.2	12	5.3
Students with Disabilities	53	39.0	13	8.4
District	138	19.4	27	3.7
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 32

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	58.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	1.9
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	10.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	24.5
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	1.4
School Level	5.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	2.0
Support Staff	1.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	0.8
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	10.0
School Nurses	2.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	41.1

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	1	1.1	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	89	98.9	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	11.4	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	0	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	16	*	14	*
White	92	97.9	122	96.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	35	97.2	44	100.0
Students with Disabilities	25	96.2	31	91.2
District	114	98.3	146	97.3
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	14	45.2
Emotional Disability	8	*
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	43	87.8
Other Health Impairment	26	70.3
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	98	69.0
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	31	4.2	2.6
Emotional Disability	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	49	6.7	6.4
Other Health Impairment	37	5.0	3.5
Other Disabilities	11	1.5	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	0	0.0	2.0
All Disabilities	142	19.4	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$11,470,415	\$15,132	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$1,647,497	\$2,229	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$254,765	\$345	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,195,029	\$1,617	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$1,605,883	\$2,173	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$1,126,797	\$1,525	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$2,175,604	\$2,944	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$1,058,880	\$1,395	\$1,582
Food services	\$194,417	\$263	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$20,729,288	\$27,347	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$889,136	20.4	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$592,186	13.6	10.2
Other Salaries	\$214,212	4.9	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$463,383	10.7	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$66,558	1.5	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,583,390	36.4	22.2
Supplies	\$34,380	0.8	0.7
Property Services	\$11	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$505,949	11.6	8.4
Equipment	\$150	0.0	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$720	0.0	0.1
Total	\$4,350,075	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		21.0	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	89.3
State	8.4
Federal	2.3
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	*	*	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	35	53.9	35	52.1	27	45.4
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	13	*	13	*	7	*
White	272	60.4	273	60.8	177	61.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	12	*	12	*	9	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	312	60.3	313	60.1	204	60.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	97	50.8	98	51.2	64	54.8
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	227	63.5	227	63.3	149	61.5
Students with Disabilities	56	44.8	56	42.2	36	52.6
Students without Disabilities	268	62.9	269	63.3	177	60.9
High Needs	124	49.7	125	49.8	82	54.5
Non-High Needs	200	66.0	200	65.8	131	62.5
District	324	59.7	325	59.6	213	59.5

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	N/A	N/A	92.0	96.9	177	93.8
Curl Up	N/A	N/A	73.2	95.4	177	81.4
Push Up	N/A	N/A	59.1	93.8	175	72.0
Mile Run/PACER	N/A	N/A	59.1	64.5	172	61.0
All Tests - District	N/A	N/A	38.0	62.9	170	47.1
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	7	*
White	115	98.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	28	96.4
Students with Disabilities	21	85.7
District	130	96.9
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	90	73.2
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	15	50.0
White	136	61.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	36	45.0
Students with Disabilities	12	20.0
District	158	59.4
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	86.8	95.7
Male	*	94.3
Non-Binary	*	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	80.5	94.7
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	66.7	*
Students with Disabilities	56.5	*
District	80.9	95.1
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	59.7	75	39.8	50	79.6	63.9
	High Needs Students	49.7	75	33.1	50	66.2	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	59.6	75	39.8	50	79.5	60.2
	High Needs Students	49.8	75	33.2	50	66.4	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	59.5	75	39.6	50	79.3	61.8
	High Needs Students	54.5	75	36.4	50	72.7	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	32.7%	100%	32.7	100	32.7	58.7%
	High Needs Students	25.1%	100%	25.1	100	25.1	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	41.1%	100%	41.1	100	41.1	61.4%
	High Needs Students	39.4%	100%	39.4	100	39.4	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	19.4%	<=5%	21.2	50	42.5	17.7%
	High Needs Students	31.9%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	97.7%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	59.4%	75%	39.6	50	79.2	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		92.1%	94%	49.0	50	97.9	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		96.9%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		94.4%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		80.9%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		74.2% 47.1%	75%	15.7	50	31.4	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		51.5%	60%	42.9	50	85.9	55.0%
Accountability Index				878.6	1350	65.1	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	66.0	49.7	16.3	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	65.8	49.8	16.0	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	62.5	54.5	8.0	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	94.4%	0.0%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	96.5
	High Needs Students	93.3
Math	All Students	96.5
	High Needs Students	93.4
Science	All Students	93.5
	High Needs Students	91.3

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: N/A

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Region 4 Schools (John Winthrop Middle School - Valley Regional High School) emphasize the academic and social development of each and every student. The focus on academic rigor in reading, mathematics, writing, and the sciences has demonstrated steady progress across the region. Curriculum revisions and professional development have focused on alignment with the Common Core State Standards. Professional development and curriculum writing are anchored in the use of technology, data analysis, and the utilization of both formative and summative assessments. School improvement plans monitor student achievement in reading, mathematics, writing, and inquiry skills. The district has implemented the use of a technology program to assist in data analysis and curriculum development.

Both schools use a professional learning community (PLC) model where time is allotted for meaningful professional conversations about student achievement. While there has been a steady growth trend, the Region 4 Schools are committed to continuous growth and improvement in meeting our goal of excellence for every student.

At JWMS and VRHS, a school-based student assistance team meets weekly to review student attendance issues and plan intervention strategies. Each week students are engaged in an advisory period and an activity period to foster deeper connections between students, staff, and the school. School staff members coordinate services for the students within our buildings to improve student attendance and active participation in the school community. If the problem persists, parents are notified by telephone and in writing when their child does not arrive at school, and other actions are taken as outlined by state statutes. At the middle school and high school, students who are identified as at-risk through the SRBI referral process for social, emotional, and/or academic concerns receive intervention support in the following ways: in-class support, small group instruction, one-on-one instruction, counseling, and in-house alternative programming. At VRHS, schedule modifications (late arrival or early dismissal) accommodate community-based internships and are also a successful intervention strategy.

In the area of special education, we have focused on increasing the co-teaching partnerships in our classrooms. Such learning environments have provided students with an exceptional student-teacher ratio and opportunities to differentiate and meet individual student needs. Our Professional Development model provides a series of workshops for teaching teams to increase the use of parallel and station teaching to better meet the needs of our diverse student population. These co-teaching teams have benefited from video modeling to expand their teaching repertoire and skill set. Each school has a skills center to provide services within our district for our students most in need of a highly individualized program.

The school websites contain valuable information for parents such as special activities and programs. The website provides parents with information on District Goals, Board of Education minutes, mission statement, Board Policies and a calendar of events. Our School Calendar-Parent Handbook is another vehicle to increase parent-school contact. Additionally, there is a mentor program to assist at-risk students that includes on-going communication with families.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

John Winthrop Middle School incorporates overarching themes of diversity, tolerance, and respect in weekly Advisory Connection Team (ACT) lessons for all students. Incoming students from three elementary schools participate in Unity Day events at JWMS to set a tone of acceptance for all students prior to their arrival. Students from JWMS have participated regularly in Middlesex Consortium's "Celebrating Differences for a Better Tomorrow" at Wesleyan University. As a result of this conference, our students have a greater understanding and appreciation of the diverse world around them.

To encourage tolerance and acceptance, all students participate in Start with Hello Day, Mix It Up Day, and Positive Youth Development Day activities, which feature opportunities for new interaction between students to celebrate differences and cultivate new relationships. In addition, programs and assemblies are scheduled throughout the year to support efforts to reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation.

The Valley Regional High School advisory program (CORE) curriculum for grades 9-12 provides many opportunities for students to engage in activities to raise awareness of discrimination, to prepare students to be active and positive citizens in a diverse, global society, and to promote acceptance of other cultures. Students actively participated in community service with Interact Club, National Honor Society, and Student Council. Students also participated in a school-wide Warriors in the Community service event that involved the entire student body and staff engaged in community service projects in all three of our towns. Each year our students also participate in a number of cultural exchanges to expand their awareness, experience, and interaction with students and families of other cultures. In addition to several educational trips to France and Spain, our students also host students from a variety of other countries.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Region 4 School District consists of John Winthrop Middle School and Valley Regional High School. Region 4 allocates resources to ensure equity and address needs each year, primarily during the budget process. The budget development process for Region 4 Schools ensures equitable allocation of resources between the two schools in the district. Building and central office administrators develop a proposed budget for the district collaboratively. Specifically, the process begins with a student enrollment projection to determine instructional needs to support student instruction, including but not limited to, staffing, textbooks, instructional supplies, and library media supplies. Analyses of expenditures from the previous school year are conducted. The analyses include a review of instructional versus non-instructional costs, the study of budgeted vs. actual expenditures, impact on facilities, etc. The budget is reviewed to ensure that it corresponds with requirements of statutes, educational goals, district policies, and collective bargaining agreements. The school budgets are combined to develop a budget that is presented to the citizens of the three towns for approval.